



■ Turn off support for UnPnP

Universal Plug and Play (UPnP) devices can be connected to any system over the network instantly—like a PnP device being connected to a local system. Windows XP supports this feature, but Microsoft has acknowledged a security flaw. Though there is a patch, it is recommended to turn off this feature—there are so few UPnP devices available anyway. Navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Services\upnphost** and double click the DWORD entry named 'Start'. To disable support for this service, give it a value of '4'; to enable it again, give it a value of '3'. If

you use any UnPnP devices over your network, leave it enabled.

■ Window refresh rate

All open windows are refreshed at a predefined interval; but when there're too many windows open, and a paucity of memory, they often appear blank—a file copied to a folder may not appear immediately on the window. This tweak allows you to set a faster refresh rate for open windows. Go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Update**. Create or modify the DWORD key called 'UpdateMode'. Assign it a value of '0' for a faster refresh rate, and '1' for default.

ANNOYANCES



■ Menu display delay

When a menu is opened, Windows opens the menu after a small delay. For example, after clicking on Start, the Programs menu takes ages to expand. This is because the 'Menushowdelay' entry has been given a large value. Open the key **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop** and modify or create a string value named 'MenuShowDelay'. In this entry, give the required delay in milliseconds; the accepted limit is 0 to 999.

■ Disable low disk space warning

Windows XP will show a warning message whenever the drive is low on disk space. For some reason, whether we have an 8 GB or 80 GB hard drive, it's never enough, and this message just gets irritating after a while. To suppress it, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows**



Stop the annoying low disk space warning

CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer and create or modify the DWORD value called 'NoLowDiskSpaceChecks'. A value of '1' will disable the warning message, '0' will enable it.

■ Disable CD burning

Windows XP comes with in-built support for CD writing. Since this offers limited functionality, power users might not need it. To disable support for CD writing, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer**. Create or modify the DWORD entry called 'NoCDBurning'. A value of '1' disables CD burning and '0' enables it.

■ Hide the links folder

Internet Explorer incessantly creates the 'Links' folder under the Favourites section, even if the user deletes it. You can get rid of it permanently by going to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Toolbar**. Set the value of the 'LinksFolderName' entry as a blank string. Now, open IE and delete the Links folder. It will no longer be displayed under Favourites.

